

$j = 1$ Representation

For $j = 1$ the Lie algebra basis elements are given by :

$$J_x = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad J_y = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 0 & -i & 0 \\ i & 0 & -i \\ 0 & i & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad J_z = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \quad (1)$$

We can write unit vector $\hat{n}$ in terms of polar angles (ψ, ϕ) as follows :

$$\hat{n} = \begin{bmatrix} \sin(\psi) \cos(\phi) \\ \sin(\phi) \sin(\psi) \\ \cos(\psi) \end{bmatrix} \quad (2)$$

Using these forms we now evaluate the following :

$$\begin{aligned} \hat{n} \cdot \vec{J} &= \sin(\psi) \cos(\phi) J_x + \sin(\phi) \sin(\psi) J_y + \cos(\psi) J_z \\ &= \frac{\sin(\psi) \cos(\phi)}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} + \frac{\sin(\phi) \sin(\psi)}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 0 & -i & 0 \\ i & 0 & -i \\ 0 & i & 0 \end{bmatrix} + \cos(\psi) \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \\ &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} \sqrt{2} \cos(\psi) & e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) & 0 \\ e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) & 0 & e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \\ 0 & e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) & -\sqrt{2} \cos(\psi) \end{bmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

We now evaluate :

$$\begin{aligned} (\hat{n} \cdot \vec{J})^2 &= (\hat{n} \cdot \vec{J}) (\hat{n} \cdot \vec{J}) \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} \sqrt{2} \cos(\psi) & e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) & 0 \\ e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) & 0 & e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \\ 0 & e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) & -\sqrt{2} \cos(\psi) \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} \sqrt{2} \cos(\psi) & e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) & 0 \\ e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) & 0 & e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \\ 0 & e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) & -\sqrt{2} \cos(\psi) \end{bmatrix} \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} \sin^2(\psi) + 2 \cos^2(\psi) & \sqrt{2} e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi) & e^{-2i\phi} \sin^2(\psi) \\ \sqrt{2} e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi) & 2 \sin^2(\psi) & -\sqrt{2} e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi) \\ e^{2i\phi} \sin^2(\psi) & -\sqrt{2} e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi) & \sin^2(\psi) + 2 \cos^2(\psi) \end{bmatrix} \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 + \cos^2(\psi) & \sqrt{2} e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi) & e^{-2i\phi} \sin^2(\psi) \\ \sqrt{2} e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi) & 2 \sin^2(\psi) & -\sqrt{2} e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi) \\ e^{2i\phi} \sin^2(\psi) & -\sqrt{2} e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi) & 1 + \cos^2(\psi) \end{bmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

Where we have used the fact that $\sin^2(\psi) + \cos^2(\psi) = 1$. Once again :

$$\begin{aligned}
 R &= (\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}})^3 = (\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}}) (\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}})^2 \\
 &= \frac{1}{2\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} \sqrt{2} \cos(\psi) & e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) & 0 \\ e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) & 0 & e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \\ 0 & e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) & -\sqrt{2} \cos(\psi) \end{bmatrix} \times \\
 &\quad \begin{bmatrix} 1 + \cos^2(\psi) & \sqrt{2} e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi) & e^{-2i\phi} \sin^2(\psi) \\ \sqrt{2} e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi) & 2 \sin^2(\psi) & -\sqrt{2} e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi) \\ e^{2i\phi} \sin^2(\psi) & -\sqrt{2} e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi) & 1 + \cos^2(\psi) \end{bmatrix} \\
 &= \frac{1}{2\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} R_{11} & R_{12} & R_{13} \\ R_{21} & R_{22} & R_{23} \\ R_{31} & R_{32} & R_{33} \end{bmatrix}
 \end{aligned}$$

Where :

$$\begin{aligned}
 R_{11} &= [\sqrt{2} \cos(\psi)] \times [1 + \cos^2(\psi)] + \sqrt{2} \sin^2(\psi) \cos(\psi) \\
 &= \sqrt{2} \cos(\psi) [1 + \cos^2(\psi) + \sin^2(\psi)] \\
 &= 2\sqrt{2} \cos(\psi)
 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 R_{12} &= [\sqrt{2} \cos(\psi)] \times [\sqrt{2} e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi)] + 2 e^{-i\phi} \sin^3(\psi) \\
 &= 2 e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos^2(\psi) + 2 e^{-i\phi} \sin^3(\psi) \\
 &= 2 e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) [\cos^2(\psi) + \sin^2(\psi)] \\
 &= 2 e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi)
 \end{aligned}$$

$$R_{13} = \sqrt{2} e^{-2i\phi} \cos(\psi) \sin^2(\psi) - \sqrt{2} e^{-2i\phi} \sin^2(\psi) \cos(\psi) = 0$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 R_{21} &= [e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi)] \times [1 + \cos^2(\psi)] + [e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi)] \times [e^{2i\phi} \sin^2(\psi)] \\
 &= e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) [1 + \cos^2(\psi) + \sin^2(\psi)] \\
 &= 2e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi)
 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 R_{22} &= [e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi)] \times [\sqrt{2} e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi)] + [e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi)] \times [-\sqrt{2} e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi)] \\
 &= \sqrt{2} \sin^2(\psi) \cos(\psi) - \sqrt{2} \sin^2(\psi) \cos(\psi) = 0
 \end{aligned}$$

$$R_{23} = [e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi)] \times [e^{-2i\phi} \sin^2(\psi)] + [e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi)] \times [1 + \cos^2(\psi)]$$

$$\begin{aligned}
&= e^{-i\phi} \sin^3(\psi) + e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) [1 + \cos^2(\psi)] \\
&= e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) [\sin^2(\psi) + 1 + \cos^2(\psi)] \\
&= 2e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi)
\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
R_{31} &= [e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi)] \times [\sqrt{2}e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi)] + [-\sqrt{2} \cos(\psi)] \times [e^{2i\phi} \sin^2(\psi)] \\
&= \sqrt{2}e^{2i\phi} \sin^2(\psi) \cos(\psi) - \sqrt{2}e^{2i\phi} \cos(\psi) \sin^2(\psi) = 0
\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
R_{32} &= [e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi)] \times [2 \sin^2(\psi)] + [-\sqrt{2} \cos(\psi)] \times [-\sqrt{2}e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi)] \\
&= 2e^{i\phi} \sin^3(\psi) + 2e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos^2(\psi) \\
&= 2e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) [\sin^2(\psi) + \cos^2(\psi)] \\
&= 2e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi)
\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
R_{33} &= [e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi)] \times [-\sqrt{2}e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi)] + [-\sqrt{2} \cos(\psi)] \times [1 + \cos^2(\psi)] \\
&= -\sqrt{2} \sin^2(\psi) \cos(\psi) - \sqrt{2} \cos(\psi) \times [1 + \cos^2(\psi)] \\
&= -\sqrt{2} \cos(\psi) [\sin^2(\psi) + 1 + \cos^2(\psi)] \\
&= -2\sqrt{2} \cos(\psi)
\end{aligned}$$

Inserting which gives us :

$$\begin{aligned}
R &= (\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}})^3 \\
&= \frac{1}{2\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} R_{11} & R_{12} & R_{13} \\ R_{21} & R_{22} & R_{23} \\ R_{31} & R_{32} & R_{33} \end{bmatrix} \\
&= \frac{1}{2\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 2\sqrt{2} \cos(\psi) & 2e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) & 0 \\ 2e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) & 0 & 2e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \\ 0 & 2e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) & -2\sqrt{2} \cos(\psi) \end{bmatrix} \\
&= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} \sqrt{2} \cos(\psi) & e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) & 0 \\ e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) & 0 & e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \\ 0 & e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) & -\sqrt{2} \cos(\psi) \end{bmatrix} = (\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}})
\end{aligned}$$

We now have the following identity :

$$\boxed{(\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}})^3 = (\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}})} \quad (3)$$

Which gives us the following relation :

$$(\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}})^{2m+1} = (\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}}) \quad (4)$$

$$(\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}})^{2m} = (\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}})^2 \quad (5)$$

Where $m \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$, i.e. $m = \{1, 2, 3, \dots\}$.

We now are in a position to write the representation of any element in $SU(2)$ corresponding to $j = 1$ representation., which is given by :

$$\rho(g) = \exp \left[-i\theta (\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}}) \right] \quad (6)$$

Expanding Eq. 6 gives :

$$\begin{aligned} \rho(g) &= \mathbb{1}_{3 \times 3} - i\theta (\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}}) + \frac{[i\theta (\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}})]^2}{2!} - \frac{[i\theta (\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}})]^3}{3!} + \dots \\ &= \mathbb{1}_{3 \times 3} + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-i\theta)^n}{n!} (\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}})^n \\ &= \mathbb{1}_{3 \times 3} + \left[\sum_{p=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-i\theta)^{2p+1}}{(2p+1)!} (\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}})^{(2p+1)} \right] + \left[\sum_{q=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-i\theta)^{2q}}{(2q)!} (\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}})^{2q} \right] \\ &= \mathbb{1}_{3 \times 3} + (\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}}) \left[\sum_{p=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-i\theta)^{2p+1}}{(2p+1)!} \right] + (\hat{\mathbf{n}} \cdot \vec{\mathbf{J}})^2 \left[\sum_{q=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-i\theta)^{2q}}{(2q)!} \right] \end{aligned}$$

We now evaluate these two sums one by one. First :

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{p=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-i\theta)^{2p+1}}{(2p+1)!} &= -i\theta + \sum_{p=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-i\theta)^{2p+1}}{(2p+1)!} \\ &= -i\theta + \sum_{p=1,3,5,\dots}^{\infty} \frac{(-i\theta)^{2p+1}}{(2p+1)!} + \sum_{p=2,4,6,\dots}^{\infty} \frac{(-i\theta)^{2p+1}}{(2p+1)!} \\ &= -i\theta + i \left(\sum_{p=1,3,5,\dots}^{\infty} \frac{(\theta)^{2p+1}}{(2p+1)!} \right) - i \left(\sum_{p=2,4,6,\dots}^{\infty} \frac{(\theta)^{2p+1}}{(2p+1)!} \right) \\ &= -i\theta + i \left[\frac{\theta^3}{3!} + \frac{\theta^7}{7!} + \dots \right] - i \left[\frac{\theta^5}{5!} + \frac{\theta^9}{9!} + \dots \right] \\ &= -i \left[\theta - \frac{\theta^3}{3!} + \frac{\theta^5}{5!} - \frac{\theta^7}{7!} + \frac{\theta^9}{9!} - \dots \right] \\ &= -i \sin \theta \end{aligned}$$

Where we have used the following arguments: $(-i)^{2m} = (-1)^{2m} \cdot (i)^{2m} = i^{2m} = -1$ if m is odd, and 1 if m is even.

Shifting our result, we can say $(-i)^{2r+1} = (-i)^{2r} \cdot (-i) = i$ if r is odd, and $-i$ if r is even.

The next sum is evaluated as follows :

$$\begin{aligned}
 \sum_{q=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-i\theta)^{2q}}{(2q)!} &= \sum_{q=1,3,5,\dots}^{\infty} \frac{(-i\theta)^{2q}}{(2q)!} + \sum_{q=2,4,6,\dots}^{\infty} \frac{(-i\theta)^{2q}}{(2q)!} \\
 &= -1 \left(\sum_{q=1,3,5,\dots}^{\infty} \frac{(\theta)^{2q}}{(2q)!} \right) + 1 \left(\sum_{q=2,4,6,\dots}^{\infty} \frac{(\theta)^{2q}}{(2q)!} \right) \\
 &= -1 \left[\frac{\theta^2}{2!} + \frac{\theta^6}{6!} + \dots \right] + 1 \left[\frac{\theta^4}{4!} + \frac{\theta^8}{8!} + \dots \right] \\
 &= -\frac{\theta^2}{2!} + \frac{\theta^4}{4!} - \frac{\theta^6}{6!} + \frac{\theta^8}{8!} - \dots \\
 &= 1 - 1 - \frac{\theta^2}{2!} + \frac{\theta^4}{4!} - \frac{\theta^6}{6!} + \frac{\theta^8}{8!} - \dots \\
 &= -1 + \left[1 - \frac{\theta^2}{2!} + \frac{\theta^4}{4!} - \frac{\theta^6}{6!} + \frac{\theta^8}{8!} - \dots \right] \\
 &= -1 + \cos \theta
 \end{aligned}$$

Which gives us the representation as :

$$\boxed{\rho(g) = \mathbb{1}_{3 \times 3} - i (\hat{n} \cdot \vec{J}) \sin \theta + (\cos \theta - 1) (\hat{n} \cdot \vec{J})^2} \quad (7)$$

Which is quite nice form. Substituting the form of $(\hat{n} \cdot \vec{J})$ and $(\hat{n} \cdot \vec{J})^2$ in this we get :

$$\begin{aligned}
 \rho(g) &= \mathbb{1}_{3 \times 3} - \frac{i \sin \theta}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} \sqrt{2} \cos(\psi) & e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) & 0 \\ e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) & 0 & e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \\ 0 & e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) & -\sqrt{2} \cos(\psi) \end{bmatrix} + \\
 &\quad \frac{(\cos \theta - 1)}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 + \cos^2(\psi) & \sqrt{2} e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi) & e^{-2i\phi} \sin^2(\psi) \\ \sqrt{2} e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi) & 2 \sin^2(\psi) & -\sqrt{2} e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi) \\ e^{2i\phi} \sin^2(\psi) & -\sqrt{2} e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi) \cos(\psi) & 1 + \cos^2(\psi) \end{bmatrix}
 \end{aligned}$$

Which gives us :

$$\rho(g) = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{(\cos^2(\psi)+1)(\cos(\theta)-1)}{2} - i \sin(\theta) \cos(\psi) + 1 & \frac{\sqrt{2}((\cos(\theta)-1) \cos(\psi) - i \sin(\theta)) e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi)}{2} & \frac{(\cos(\theta)-1) e^{-2i\phi} \sin^2(\psi)}{2} \\ \frac{\sqrt{2}((\cos(\theta)-1) \cos(\psi) - i \sin(\theta)) e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi)}{2} & (\cos(\theta) - 1) \sin^2(\psi) + 1 & \frac{\sqrt{2}(-(\cos(\theta)-1) \cos(\psi) - i \sin(\theta)) e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi)}{2} \\ \frac{(\cos(\theta)-1) e^{2i\phi} \sin^2(\psi)}{2} & \frac{\sqrt{2}(-(\cos(\theta)-1) \cos(\psi) - i \sin(\theta)) e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi)}{2} & \frac{(\cos^2(\psi)+1)(\cos(\theta)-1)}{2} + i \sin(\theta) \cos(\psi) + 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\rho(g) = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{(\cos^2(\psi)+1)(\cos(\theta)-1)}{2} - i \sin(\theta) \cos(\psi) + 1 & \frac{\sqrt{2}((\cos(\theta)-1) \cos(\psi) - i \sin(\theta)) e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi)}{2} & \frac{(\cos(\theta)-1) e^{-2i\phi} \sin^2(\psi)}{2} \\ \frac{\sqrt{2}((\cos(\theta)-1) \cos(\psi) - i \sin(\theta)) e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi)}{2} & (\cos(\theta) - 1) \sin^2(\psi) + 1 & \frac{\sqrt{2}(-(\cos(\theta)-1) \cos(\psi) - i \sin(\theta)) e^{-i\phi} \sin(\psi)}{2} \\ \frac{(\cos(\theta)-1) e^{2i\phi} \sin^2(\psi)}{2} & \frac{\sqrt{2}(-(\cos(\theta)-1) \cos(\psi) - i \sin(\theta)) e^{i\phi} \sin(\psi)}{2} & \frac{(\cos^2(\psi)+1)(\cos(\theta)-1)}{2} + i \sin(\theta) \cos(\psi) + 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad (8)$$